



AKHANDJYOTI  
EYE HOSPITAL

Sight. Life. Hope.



# VISION

DRIVEN BY

PURPOSE



ANNUAL REPORT  
2025-26

Eye Health | Targeted Rural Intervention | Women Empowerment



# Vision Driven by Purpose

Purpose is most expressed in the lives it transforms.

True vision goes beyond ambition; it's about finding meaning in it. For Akhand Jyoti, that purpose extends beyond restoring sight. It's about creating an ecosystem that addresses avoidable blindness, improves access to quality care, empowers communities, and builds lasting opportunities.



The future of eye care can't be built by hospitals alone. Guided by Vision 2030, we're strengthening one of Eastern India's largest rural eye care ecosystems by expanding clinical capacity, investing in technology, research, outreach, and talent. Every step forward is guided by purpose: eliminating avoidable blindness and enabling healthier, more independent lives through integrated quality eye care, rural intervention, and women's empowerment.





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# Leadership Reflections

Voices Behind the Vision



Pandit Shri Ramesh  
Chandra Shukla

Social Reformer &  
Founding Chairman Trustee

## Inspiration from our Late Chairman

Pandit Shri Ramesh Chandra Shukla believed that helping someone see again was one of the greatest forms of service. Inspired by Gayatri Parivar's guiding principle of 'Sewa for All' and the teachings of Pandit Shriram Sharma Acharya, he encouraged people to become the eyes of those who could not see. He believed that restoring sight could help people work, learn, care for their families, and live with confidence. Today, Akhand Jyoti continues his mission by eliminating curable blindness and empowering rural girls, carrying forward the values he lived by every day.

# Leadership Reflections

## Voices Behind the Vision

### A Word from Our Co-Founder & CEO

Every institution reaches a point when the question is no longer how much more can we do? but what are we building, and what purpose does it serve?

For Akhand Jyoti, that question has shaped our journey from a modest rural eye hospital into a growing ecosystem of five surgical hospitals and 50+ vision centres. In FY 2025-26 alone, our teams performed 185,500+ sight-restoring surgeries, a measure not simply of scale, but of the systems, capabilities and trust built over two decades.

We have learned that restoring sight is only one part of the opportunity. Lasting impact comes from building the systems, capabilities and human capital that enable communities to access quality care and participate more fully in their futures.

This philosophy continues to guide our strategic priorities: strengthening clinical excellence, expanding decentralised access, investing in technology and research, and developing talent. Our work with rural girls is central to this vision, creating pathways for 1,500 young women by 2030 to gain education, professional opportunity and leadership.

As we look ahead, new strategic partnerships taking shape will further strengthen our capabilities and extend the possibilities of what we can build together.

For us, Vision Driven by Purpose means ensuring that ambition remains accountable to impact. The true measure of progress is not simply how far we grow, but how many lives are transformed through what we build.

We thank every partner, colleague and supporter who continues to invest in this shared vision.



**Mritunjay Tiwary**

Co-Founder & CEO  
Akhand Jyoti Eye Hospital

# Leadership Reflections

## Voices Behind the Vision



**Dr Ajit Kumar Poddar**

Medical Director  
Akhand Jyoti Eye Hospital

## A Word from Our Medical Director

Throughout my years in ophthalmology, one principle has remained constant: clinical excellence is not defined by technology, volume or individual expertise alone. It is defined by the discipline with which an institution brings these elements together—and by the trust it earns from every patient.

At Akhand Jyoti, this responsibility is reflected in the scale and consistency of our clinical work. During the year, our teams performed more than 185,500 sight-restoring surgeries, while continuing to strengthen the systems, standards and clinical practices that underpin every outcome.

Yet, excellence must never be measured by numbers alone. This year also marked important steps in our clinical and academic journey. Akhand Jyoti performed its first corneal transplant, expanding the range of specialised care available to patients across Bihar. Our ophthalmology fellows continued to engage in research, contributing to scientific publications and strengthening a culture where clinical experience is translated into evidence and shared knowledge.

As ophthalmic care evolves, our responsibility is to remain uncompromising in quality while preparing for the needs of tomorrow. This means investing in rigorous systems, evidence-led practice, continuous learning, responsible innovation and the development of professionals who combine technical expertise with empathy and sound judgement.

For me, a resilient institution is one that turns expertise into systems, systems into standards, and standards into consistently better patient outcomes.

As Akhand Jyoti grows, I remain committed to ensuring that the individual patient stays at the centre of every clinical decision we make.

# Leadership Reflections

## Voices Behind the Vision

### A Word from Our Chairman, Advisory Board

At its core, institution-building is an exercise in stewardship. It is about having the foresight to anticipate what lies ahead, the discipline to build for the long term, and the conviction to ensure that growth remains anchored in purpose.

Over the years, Akhand Jyoti has demonstrated that meaningful scale and meaningful impact need not be competing priorities. Its evolution into a rural eye care ecosystem reflects a deliberate institutional approach, one that brings together clinical excellence, decentralised access, technology, talent and community participation.

What distinguishes this journey is not merely the scale of its operations, but the intent behind them. Akhand Jyoti has consistently sought to address the structural dimensions of avoidable blindness while creating pathways for communities to become participants in their own development. Its investment in rural women is particularly significant: it demonstrates how healthcare, employability and empowerment can converge to create value well beyond the clinical encounter.

As the organisation enters its next phase, the opportunity is to institutionalise this impact further to strengthen governance, deepen capabilities, embrace innovation and forge partnerships that can expand both reach and relevance.

This is where Vision Driven by Purpose acquires its fullest meaning. Vision provides the direction; purpose provides the discipline to remain true to why the journey began.

Akhand Jyoti's future will be shaped not only by what it accomplishes, but by the institution it continues to build resilient, accountable and capable of creating enduring value for the communities it serves.

I am privileged to witness and support this journey.



**Shri Ravi Kant**

Chairman, Advisory Board

# Leadership Reflections

## Voices Behind the Vision



**(Prof.) Dr Rajvardhan Azad**  
Chairman,  
Clinical Research Advisory Board

## A Word from Our Chairman, Clinical Research Advisory Board

The strongest healthcare institutions are not simply providers of care; they are institutions that continuously learn, question and evolve.

Akhand Jyoti is moving in that direction. As its clinical footprint expands, its ability to convert experience into knowledge—and knowledge into better outcomes—will become increasingly important to the future of eye care in underserved communities.

The Akhand Jyoti Institute of Community Ophthalmology (AJICO) is an important expression of this philosophy. As the organisation's academic arm, it brings clinicians and emerging leaders closer to the realities of community ophthalmology, creating an environment where real-world clinical practice fuels research, and research, in turn, informs better care.

This relationship between practice and evidence is particularly valuable in rural and underserved settings, where conventional models often need to be reimagined around local realities. Building institutional capacity to study these realities, evaluate outcomes and disseminate learning can create value far beyond individual interventions.

I am encouraged by Akhand Jyoti's growing emphasis on scientific enquiry, academic engagement and knowledge-sharing. These capabilities will be critical as the institution seeks not only to expand access, but to continuously raise the quality and effectiveness of that access.

Vision Driven by Purpose therefore has a deeper meaning in the context of clinical research: to ensure that every advancement is informed by evidence, every insight has the potential to improve practice, and every innovation ultimately translates into better outcomes for patients and communities.

I look forward to Akhand Jyoti strengthening this cycle of care, enquiry, evidence and impact in the years ahead.

# Leadership Reflections

## Voices Behind the Vision

### A Word from Our Vice Chairman, Advisory Board

Enduring institutions are built when ambition is matched by the ability to execute, adapt and create value at scale.

Over the years, Akhand Jyoti has evolved from a bold idea into a distinctive rural eye care institution, demonstrating that scale and social impact can be pursued with equal rigour. What stands out is not simply the breadth of its operations, but the institutional architecture being built around them, clinical excellence, decentralised access, talent, technology, partnerships and community engagement working as an integrated ecosystem.

The next phase of this journey is particularly compelling. Akhand Jyoti has the opportunity to build one of the largest and most comprehensive rural eye care ecosystems in India, one that does more than expand access, but sets a stronger benchmark for how quality healthcare can be delivered sustainably in underserved geographies.

Realising this ambition will require continued investment in organisational capability, innovation and strategic partnerships. It will also require the discipline to scale thoughtfully, preserving the quality, credibility and community orientation that have shaped the institution's journey.

What gives me confidence is the clarity of purpose behind this growth. Akhand Jyoti is building not merely for the next milestone, but for an institution capable of creating enduring impact across generations.

The opportunity ahead is significant: to transform a successful model into a high-performing, resilient and scalable ecosystem for eye care, while demonstrating that purpose-led institutions can deliver both social value and operational excellence.

I am privileged to support Akhand Jyoti as it enters this important next chapter.



**Shri Jayesh Parekh**

Vice Chairman,  
Advisory Board

# Leadership Reflections

## Voices Behind the Vision



**Shri Himanshu Ashar**

Advisor, Finance & Administration

## A Word from Our Advisor

Finance & Administration

One of the greatest privileges of working in finance and administration is seeing how strong institutions are built. Behind every milestone lies careful planning, responsible stewardship, and the systems that enable an organisation to grow with confidence, integrity, and purpose.

This year, as Akhand Jyoti expanded its reach and strengthened its capacity, we remained focused on reinforcing financial governance, streamlining administrative processes, strengthening accountability, and building systems that support timely, informed decision making. While these efforts often remain behind the scenes, they provide the foundation that enables every programme, partnership, and investment to deliver meaningful outcomes.

A key priority has been long term stewardship. Every investment is evaluated not only for its immediate value, but also for how it strengthens the institution for the future. Whether through stronger financial systems, technology that improves operational effectiveness, or investments in people, each decision contributes to a more resilient organisation.

As Akhand Jyoti advances towards Vision 2030, we remain committed to managing every resource with transparency, accountability, and purpose, ensuring we can expand rural eye care, eliminate curable blindness, and empower the next generation of women leaders.

# Leadership Reflections

## Voices Behind the Vision

### A Word from Our Chairman

Technical Advisory Board

The future of healthcare will be shaped not just by technology, but by how effectively it improves access, strengthens clinical decision making, and enhances patient outcomes. The institutions that lead tomorrow will be those that use innovation with purpose.

Akhand Jyoti has embraced this approach with clarity. Technology is not an end in itself, but a means to make specialised eye care more accessible, equip clinicians with better tools, and build systems prepared for the future.

Over the past year, this commitment has been reflected in investments in digital infrastructure, stronger hospital information systems, and the expansion of technology enabled care. The growth of Tele Eye Health Centres is helping bridge geographical barriers, while advances in artificial intelligence and research are enabling earlier diagnosis, better clinical decisions, and improved patient outcomes. Simulation based training and technology enabled education are also preparing future ophthalmologists and eye care professionals to meet global standards.

As the Technical Advisory Board, our role is to ensure these investments remain purposeful, scalable, and aligned with the institution's long term vision. I am confident that Akhand Jyoti is building a strong technological foundation to advance rural eye care for years to come.



**Shri Raja Sekhar Kommu**

Chairman,  
Technical Advisory Board

# Akhand Jyoti Board

## People behind the Mission

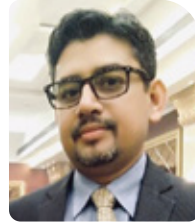
### Key Members of Trustee Board



Mritunjay Tiwary  
Co-Founder &  
Executive Trustee



Snehanand (Ravi) Sinha  
Strategic Advisor  
& Trustee



Atul Kumar  
Legal Advisor & Trustee



(Prof.) Dr Rajesh Vishwakarma  
Medical Advisor & Trustee

### Members of Advisory Board



Ravi Kant  
Chairman, Advisory Board



Jayesh Parekh  
Member, Advisory Board



Amish Nathwani  
Member, Advisory Board



Prof. Mala Sinha  
Member, Advisory Board



Ramesh Jude Thomas  
Member, Advisory Board



Shashi Sinha  
Member, Advisory Board



(Prof.) Dr Rajvardhan Azad  
Chairman, Clinical &  
Research Advisory Board



Dr Ajit Kumar Poddar  
Medical Director



Himanshu Ashar  
Advisor,  
Finance & Administration



Raja Sekhar Kommu  
Chairman,  
Technology Advisory Board

# About Akhand Jyoti

## The Journey behind Twenty Years of Legacy

Akhand Jyoti, founded in 2005 as a unit of the Yugrishi Shriram Sharma Acharya Charitable Trust (YSSACT), is a women-led non-profit organisation, working to eliminate curable blindness from the face of Bihar and other underserved regions of India.

Akhand Jyoti is one of Eastern India's top five eye hospitals. Its operations are headquartered in the remote Indian village of Mastichak in Bihar. With a 200-bed hospital in Mastichak, a 500-bed 1st Centre of Excellence in Eastern India, 40-bed hospitals in Patna, Dalsingsarai, and Ballia (Uttar Pradesh), a 60-bed

hospital in Purnea, and 50+ Primary Vision Centres spread across various strategic rural locations of Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, & Uttarakhand.

Akhand Jyoti performs approximately 1,85,500+ sight-restoring surgeries annually, of which 80% are provided free of charge to underprivileged and indigent patients, including children, and screens around 27,00,000 patients yearly. Our mission to eliminate curable blindness, spanning two decades, is built upon these three core pillars:



## Eye Health

Delivering advanced treatment to restore vision, break cycles of poverty, and improve quality of life.

## Targeted Rural Interventions

Taking eye care directly to underserved communities across Bihar.



## Women's Empowerment

Training and enabling women to become leaders in eye care, creating lasting social change.

# Our Mission & Vision

## A Purpose Rooted in Possibility

### Mission

To transform society through a unique model of empowerment that turns rural women into social change agents through education and optometry training, and eliminates curable blindness by making world-class eye care affordable and accessible to low-income areas.

### Vision

To eliminate gender bias and curable blindness by empowering women to lead the change towards creating a blind free Bihar.



# Our Work

## Building Systems That Remove Barriers

In many rural communities, the barriers that shape a person's future are rarely isolated. A lack of access to eye care can delay education, limit economic participation, and reduce independence. At the same time, deeply rooted gender inequalities continue to restrict opportunities for girls, preventing them from reaching their full potential and contributing fully to the development of their communities.

These challenges often exist side-by-side. So does the opportunity to address them together. At Akhand Jyoti,

our work is built on a simple belief: when people can access quality eye care, and girls are equipped with the knowledge, confidence, and opportunities to lead, communities become healthier, stronger, and more resilient. This belief guides two interconnected initiatives that advance our mission while creating pathways for long-term social change.



## Blindness Elimination Programme

For millions of people living in underserved regions, preventable blindness remains not only a health challenge but also a barrier to participation, productivity, and well-being.

Through the Blindness Elimination Programme, Akhand Jyoti delivers a continuum of care that connects communities to screenings, diagnosis, treatment, surgery, and follow-up services. Supported by outreach camps, Vision Centres, vision vans, hospitals, and the Centre of Excellence, the programme is designed to bring quality eye care closer to those who need it most.

By strengthening access at every stage of the patient journey, the programme helps ensure that avoidable vision loss does not become a lifelong limitation.

# 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme

Creating lasting change requires more than delivering services. It requires investing in people who will shape the future of their communities.

The 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme uses sport as an entry point to identify, nurture, and support rural girls on a journey towards education, leadership, and employment. Through academic support, life skills development, professional training, and career pathways in eye care, girls are equipped to become skilled healthcare professionals and agents of change within their own communities.

As more girls enter the workforce and take on leadership roles, they help expand access to care while creating new possibilities for the next generation.



## Our Theory of Change

Because blindness and visual impairment hinder socio-economic development and perpetuate poverty, we work with underserved communities in rural India to help the poorest and most marginalised sections regain their sight and improve their livelihoods by providing high-quality, affordable eye care while empowering girls as social change agents through our 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme, in order to significantly impact curable blindness by completing 12 million eye screenings and 2 million eye surgeries while empowering 1500 girls by 2030.

# The Problem of Blindness

## The Gap Between Need and Care

For many people, the difference between receiving treatment and living without it is not medicine. It is access. A condition may be preventable. A treatment may be available. A solution may already exist. Yet barriers such as distance, affordability, awareness, and limited access to healthcare continue to keep care out of reach for millions.

Blindness is one of the clearest examples of this reality. Despite being largely preventable or treatable, blindness continues to disproportionately affect low-income populations. Nearly 90% of the world's blind live in low-income countries, with India alone accounting for one in every five blind individuals globally.\*

The leading cause, cataract, is treatable. Yet millions continue to live with avoidable vision loss because care remains beyond their reach. Delayed diagnosis, financial

constraints, and limited availability of services often prevent people from receiving timely treatment.

The consequences extend far beyond health. When vision loss goes untreated, educational opportunities narrow, economic participation declines, and existing inequalities deepen. Women are often affected disproportionately, facing additional barriers in accessing healthcare and treatment.

Blindness, therefore, reflects more than a medical challenge. It reveals the gaps that continue to exist between available healthcare and the people who need it most. Addressing it requires more than treatment alone. It requires stronger pathways to care, greater awareness, and systems capable of reaching underserved communities at scale.

\*Published on MedIndia.net, Article Topic: India Has One-fifth of the Total Global Blind Population

## Economic Impact

### The Problem

Annual welfare cost of moderate to severe visual impairment (MSVI) and blindness in India is estimated at ₹1,158 billion (INR947-1,427 billion), equivalent to approximately 0.57% of India's GDP.

(Source: Wong B, Singh K, Khanna RK, Ravilla T, Shalinder S, Sil A, Dole K, Jain E, Chase H. The economic and social costs of visual impairment and blindness in India. Indian J Ophthalmol. 2022 Oct.)

### The Solution

Cataract surgery, one of the most affordable, scalable, and effective healthcare interventions available today, has been shown to significantly improve income and productivity.

Beyond restoring sight, timely treatment can help individuals participate more fully in education, livelihoods, and community life while reducing the wider social and economic costs associated with avoidable blindness.

Source: Vishwakarma, P, A. Mondal, D. Ranpise, L. Sundararaj, S. Shaikh, S. Chavan, and E. Kurian. "Impact of Cataract on the Livelihood Income Status of Patients Availing Free Cataract Surgery in India". International Journal of Community Medicine and Public Health. Vol. 12, No. 6, May 2025, pp. 2627-33





## Bihar: Where the Need Is Greatest

### The Challenge Behind Reaching Millions

Bihar's development story is often discussed through the lens of population, economic growth, and opportunity. Less visible, however, are the healthcare challenges that continue to shape everyday life for millions of people across the state.

Eye care is one of them. Despite significant progress in the treatment of avoidable blindness, access to care remains uneven. Large populations continue to live far from quality eye care services, while the availability of trained professionals and surgical facilities remains insufficient to meet existing demand.

The result is a persistent gap between need and access. Bihar's surgical capacity currently meets only a fraction of the demand required to address avoidable blindness. At the same time, the state has among the lowest numbers of ophthalmologists, optometrists, and eye beds relative to its population, leaving many

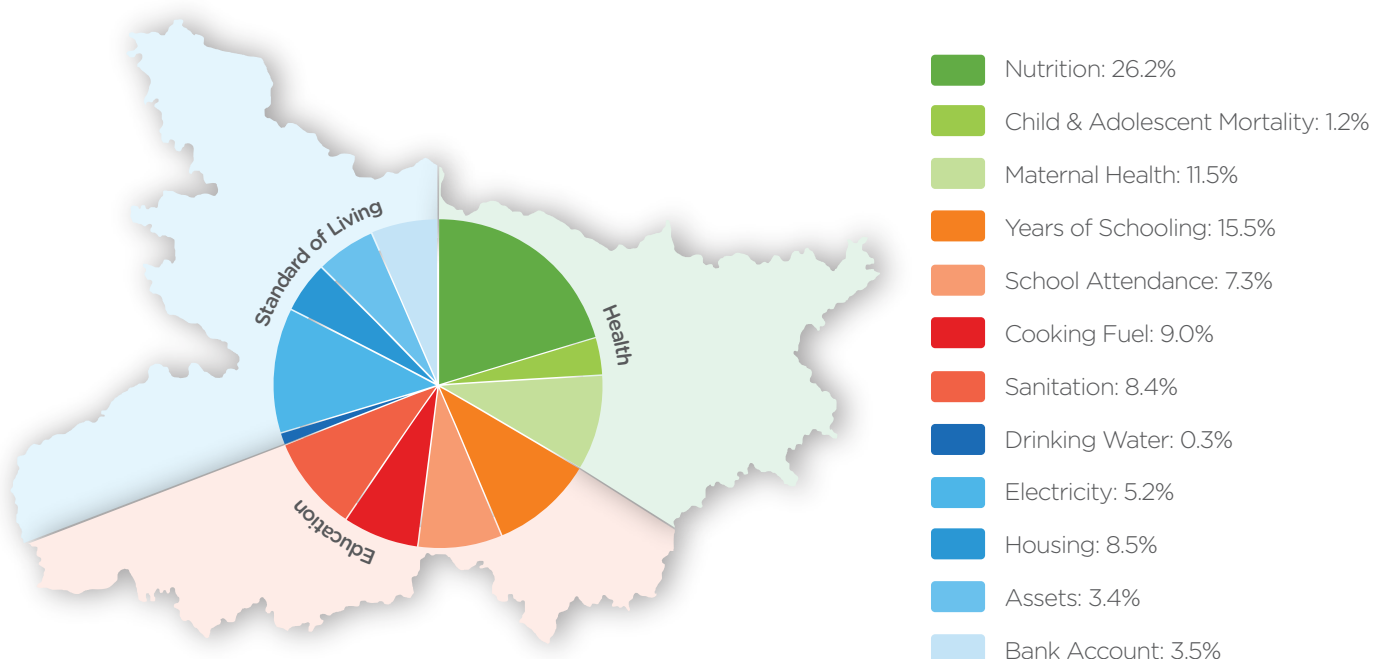
communities underserved and vulnerable to delayed treatment.

This challenge extends beyond healthcare alone. When access to eye care remains limited, the effects are felt across families, livelihoods, education, and community wellbeing. Conditions that can often be treated continue to affect lives simply because care is not available within reach.

Yet this challenge also presents an opportunity. By strengthening local capacity, expanding access points, and bringing quality eye care closer to underserved communities, it is possible to reduce avoidable blindness while addressing broader barriers linked to poverty, inequality, and access. For Akhand Jyoti, Bihar is not simply where the need is significant. It is where meaningful change can reach millions.

# Bihar:

## Indicator-Wise Contribution to the Multidimensional Poverty Index



Bihar consistently ranks at the bottom in parameters like education, healthcare access, and income, exacerbating the cycle of poverty and preventable blindness.

## Bihar's Eye Health Overview

### Eye Surgery

Bihar has the lowest number of eye surgeries compared to the national average.

2,599 Bihar

India's Average: 6,012

### Eye Bed

Bihar has the lowest number of eye surgery beds compared to the national average.

32 Bihar

India's Average: 72

### Ophthalmologist

Bihar has one of the lowest ophthalmologists for every one million people across the state.

5 Bihar

India's Average: 15

### Optometrist

Bihar has one of the lowest optometrists serving every one million people across the state.

5 Bihar

India's Average: 13

Data Per Million Population

Bihar has the lowest number of Ophthalmic manpower compared to the national average.

### Bihar's Annual Surgical Capacity

2,00,000  
Existing

5,00,000  
Required

### Incidence of Eye Problem in Rural Bihar

30%  
Rural

70%  
Urban

The Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) measures the percentage of households in a country deprived along three dimensions – monetary poverty, education, and basic infrastructure services – to capture a more complete picture of poverty. It is a means to capture the complexity of poverty that considers dimensions of well-being beyond just monetary poverty.

Source: World Bank

# The Courage She Carried Forward

Story of  
**Jyoti Kumari**



Stories of Change



As the eldest of four children, Jyoti Kumari learnt early that her choices were rarely hers alone. She dreamed of becoming a doctor, but her family's financial circumstances made it difficult to continue her education. In 2023, she joined Akhand Jyoti through the Football to Eyeball Girls' Empowerment Programme and began studying optometry.

Her days are now spent moving between lectures, practical classes, and long hours of learning as she works towards a Bachelor's degree in Optometry. At home, her younger sister watches her leave for class each morning. For Jyoti, continuing her education is more than a personal milestone. It is quietly changing what the next girl in her family believes is possible.



# Blindness Elimination Programme

## An Eye Care, Built to Reach Everyone

For many people in underserved communities, blindness is often the result of delayed diagnosis and limited access to timely eye care rather than the eye condition itself. Since many causes of blindness and visual impairment are preventable or treatable, expanding access to quality care remains key to restoring sight and preventing avoidable vision loss.

Akhand Jyoti's Blindness Elimination Programme addresses this challenge by delivering accessible, affordable, and high-quality eye care to underserved populations across Bihar and Eastern Uttar Pradesh, regions that continue to bear a significant burden of avoidable blindness.

Through a network of outreach camps, Vision Centres, vision vans, hospital-based services, and community awareness initiatives, the programme connects people to screening, diagnosis, treatment, surgery, and follow-up care. Patients are supported throughout their journey, with transportation assistance and personalised care helping remove some of the most significant barriers to accessing treatment.

By bringing care closer to communities and strengthening pathways to treatment, the programme works to ensure that avoidable blindness does not become a lifelong barrier to health, opportunity, and participation.

## Impact Snapshot

FY 2025-26

1,85,569

Eye Surgeries

24,59,935

Eye Screenings

18,600

Outreach Camps

1,46,061

Paediatric  
Eye Screenings

2,23,323

Eyeglasses  
Dispensed

“

Every number  
represents a life  
we have touched.  
Every life inspires  
us to do more.

# Our Working Model

## A Network Designed to Eliminate Blindness

Access to quality eye care does not begin at a hospital. It begins much closer to where people live. In rural communities, timely treatment often depends on whether individuals can be identified early, guided through the healthcare system, and connected to the appropriate level of care. Recognising this, Akhand Jyoti has developed an integrated eye care model that links community outreach with progressively advanced levels of clinical services.

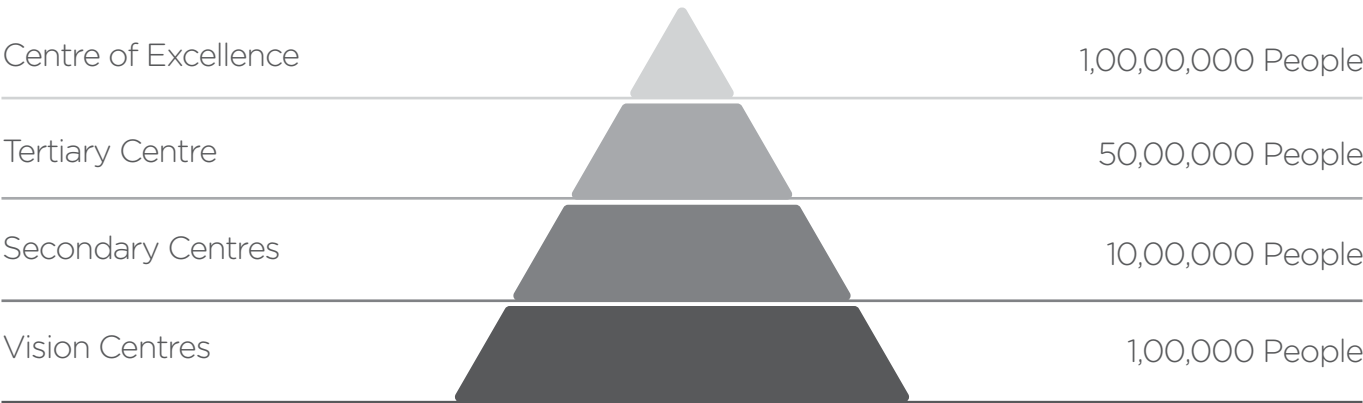
Designed as a pyramid, the model combines scale with continuity. Vision Centres serve as the first point of contact for communities, providing accessible eye care closer to home. Patients requiring specialised treatment are referred through secondary and tertiary centres, with the Centre of Excellence providing advanced clinical care for complex cases.

This interconnected approach helps ensure that patients receive the right care at the right time while strengthening access across every stage of the care journey.

At the heart of this model are the women emerging from the 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme. As optometrists, Vision Centre leaders, and eye care professionals, they help extend services into underserved communities while contributing to a stronger and more inclusive eye care workforce.

Together, these interconnected layers create a system capable of reaching millions while ensuring that quality, affordability, and continuity of care remain central to every patient journey.

## A structured model, designed to serve a defined population, ensuring the right care scales with need



# Vision Centres

Vision Centres serve as the first point of contact in Akhand Jyoti's eye care network. Located within underserved communities and staffed by trained rural girls and local professionals, they make primary eye care accessible closer to where people live while strengthening referral pathways to higher levels of care. For many people, the Vision Centre is where an eye care journey begins, whether through a routine

screening, a consultation, or the identification of a condition requiring further attention.

Patients can receive primary eye care, diagnosis and referrals without making a long journey to a hospital. The centres also create opportunities for trained rural girls to take on greater responsibility within their communities. Many graduates of the 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme now lead and manage Vision Centres, combining clinical skills with leadership and entrepreneurial responsibilities.



## Key Highlights

- Serve around 1,00,000 people across a cluster of villages.
- Staffed by trained rural girls and local professionals.
- Provide primary eye care, screenings, diagnosis, and referrals.
- Led by graduates of the 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme, many of whom take on leadership and entrepreneurial responsibilities in managing the centres.

# Secondary Eye Hospitals

Secondary Eye Hospitals bridge the gap between community-based services and advanced clinical care. Designed to deliver high-volume, high-quality cataract surgeries and post-operative care, these hospitals ensure that patients can access treatment closer to home without travelling long distances. They form an important part of the referral pathway, receiving patients from Vision Centres who require surgical or more specialised intervention.

Alongside cataract surgery, the hospitals provide diagnosis and treatment for major ophthalmic conditions, allowing patients to receive a wider range of care within their region. Their teams of optometrists and allied eye care professionals support patients throughout the process, from clinical assessment and counselling to surgical assistance and follow-up. Together, these hospitals help distribute surgical capacity across the network and bring treatment closer to underserved communities.



## Key Highlights

- Each hospital serves approximately 1 million people.
- Currently located at Patna (40 beds), Purnea (60 beds), Dalsinghsarai (40 beds), and Ballia in Uttar Pradesh (40 beds).
- Provide diagnosis and treatment for major ophthalmic conditions alongside high-quality cataract surgeries.
- Supported by trained optometrists and allied eye care professionals who contribute across patient care, counselling, and surgical assistance.

# Tertiary Eye Hospital

Akhand Jyoti's Tertiary Eye Hospital provides specialised treatment for complex eye conditions while supporting higher volumes of surgical care. Serving as an important link between secondary hospitals and advanced clinical services, it ensures that patients can access specialised treatment closer to home. The 200-bed facility at Mastichak brings together diagnosis, treatment and high-quality cataract surgery while serving a population of around 5 million people. Its role also extends to developing the people who deliver care.

Trained rural girls working across Akhand Jyoti's network can progress into more specialised areas through mentorship and knowledge transfer, gaining exposure to advanced clinical practices and broader responsibilities. In this way, the facility strengthens both access to specialised care and the professional development of the workforce supporting rural eye health.



## Key Highlights

- Serves around 5 million people.
- Currently represented by a 200-bed facility at Mastichak, Saran.
- Offers diagnosis and treatment for major ophthalmic conditions alongside high-quality cataract surgeries.
- Provides opportunities for trained rural girls to progress from frontline eye care roles into more specialised areas through mentorship and knowledge transfer.

# Centre of Excellence

The Centre of Excellence represents the highest level of care within Akhand Jyoti's eye care network. Serving around 10 million people across Bihar and neighbouring regions, it receives the most complex cases referred through the wider network and provides advanced subspecialty services. Its role extends beyond clinical care to building the knowledge and skills needed to strengthen rural eye health over the long term. Doctors and optometrists receive evidence-based

medical training, while the Centre provides an environment for learning, research, innovation and advocacy. By bringing these functions together, the Centre of Excellence creates a stronger connection between patient care, professional development and knowledge generation. It also helps nurture future specialists, researchers and healthcare leaders who can contribute to expanding the quality and reach of eye care across underserved regions.



## Key Highlights

- Serves around 10 million people across Bihar and neighbouring regions.
- Provides advanced subspecialty services and evidence-based medical training for doctors and optometrists.
- Handles the most complex eye care cases referred through the wider network.
- Functions as a hub for learning, research, innovation, and advocacy.
- Strengthens the long-term capacity of rural eye care by nurturing future specialists, researchers, and healthcare leaders.

# Our Care Delivery Model

## Ensuring No one is left behind

Quality eye care can only create impact when people are able to access it in time. Across rural and underserved communities, barriers such as distance, limited awareness, and delayed diagnosis often prevent people from seeking care until vision problems have progressed significantly. Addressing avoidable blindness, therefore, requires more than clinical expertise. It requires a delivery model capable of reaching people where they are, identifying need early, and connecting individuals to appropriate care.

Akhand Jyoti's Care Delivery Model is designed around this principle. Through outreach screening programme, Vision Centres, surgical hospitals, paediatric eye screening programmes, and Drishti Saathi vision vans, eye care is brought closer to communities while creating clear pathways to diagnosis, treatment, surgery, and follow-up care. Together, these interconnected interventions help ensure that timely eye care is not determined by geography, awareness, or access, but by need.

## Outreach Camps Taking Eye Care to the Last Mile

For many people living in rural communities, the journey to eye care does not begin at a hospital or a Vision Centre. It begins much closer to home. Distance, limited awareness, and the cost of travel can often delay treatment, particularly for older adults and those living in underserved areas. Outreach Camps help bridge this gap by bringing eye care services directly into communities, making early screening and diagnosis more accessible.

Organised across villages and local gathering points, these camps serve as an important entry point into

Akhand Jyoti's wider care network. Individuals identified with eye conditions are guided towards appropriate treatment pathways, including Vision Centres and surgical hospitals, if required.

Beyond screening, Outreach Camps help build awareness around eye health, encourage earlier care-seeking behaviour, and strengthen community trust in the healthcare system. By bringing services closer to where people live, they play a vital role in ensuring that access to quality eye care begins long before a patient reaches a hospital.

## Impact Snapshot FY 2025-26

Patients Screened

5,79,071

Camps Organised

10,698



Screening Is the  
First Step in  
Connecting People  
to Timely  
Treatment



# Life Returns to His Little Shop

Story of  
**Shiv Shankar Sah**



For years, Shiv Shankar Sah began each morning preparing samosas at his shop in Berai, Muzaffarpur. But when cataract slowly blurred his vision, serving customers, counting money and working over the wood fire chulha became difficult. Eventually, he had to close his shop and depend on his wife for everyday tasks.

Then an Akhand Jyoti awareness vehicle reached his village, offering him a chance to seek treatment. After cataract surgery, Shiv Shankar returned to his shop. Today, he prepares samosas, serves familiar customers and earns a living independently once again. The familiar rhythm of his mornings has returned, along with the confidence to work and provide for his family.



Stories of Change



# Vision Centres

## The First Point of Access to Eye Care

In rural Bihar, a simple eye examination can sometimes require a long journey, a day's wages, and time away from work and family. For many people, these challenges often mean postponing care until vision problems become difficult to ignore.

Vision Centres were created to change this. Located within villages and small towns, these centres are designed following 'hub and spoke model' that brings primary eye care closer to communities, making services available within walking distance for many patients. Individuals can walk in, receive eye examinations, access tele ophthalmology consultations with expert surgeons, and, if required, be referred to the nearest Akhand Jyoti hospitals for further treatment.

But Vision Centres are more than local access points. Many are led by girls trained through the 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme, who have gone on to become optometrists, entrepreneurs, and trusted health professionals within their communities. In doing so, they are helping strengthen local healthcare systems while encouraging communities to seek care earlier.

By combining community-based care with local leadership, Vision Centres are helping make quality eye care more accessible, trusted, and sustainable.

**Care Model:** Community-based, walk-in eye care

**Led By:** Girl optometrists trained at Akhand Jyoti

**Services:** Primary eye care, referrals, and eyeglasses

**Connected Through:** Tele ophthalmology consultations with expert surgeons

**Leadership Pathway:** Senior optometrists encouraged to take on entrepreneurial roles

**Annual Reach:** Each Vision Centre serves around 3,000 to 5,000 patients annually

## Impact Snapshot

FY 2025-26

1,04,933

Eyeglasses  
Dispensed

3,34,864

People Screened  
at VC Camps

3,41,232

People Screened  
at VC OPD

48

Vision Centres  
Opened



”  
For Rural  
Communities, a  
Vision Centre Brings  
Essential Eye Care  
Closer to Home

# Surgical Centres

## Specialised Eye Care, Closer to Communities

As eye conditions become more complex, access to specialised diagnosis and surgical care becomes increasingly important. Akhand Jyoti's network of Surgical Centres extends advanced eye care beyond its Centre of Excellence, ensuring that more people can receive timely treatment closer to where they live.

Together, these centres provide comprehensive diagnosis, cataract surgery, and treatment for a wide range of ophthalmic conditions, while strengthening referral

As eye conditions become more complex, access to specialised diagnosis and surgical care becomes increasingly important. Akhand Jyoti's network of Surgical Centres extends advanced eye care beyond its Centre of Excellence, ensuring that more people can receive timely treatment closer to where they live.

Together, these centres provide comprehensive diagnosis, cataract surgery, and treatment for a wide range of ophthalmic conditions, while strengthening referral

## Impact Snapshot

FY 2025-26

| Mastichak, Saran |                         |          |                               |
|------------------|-------------------------|----------|-------------------------------|
| 2,74,685         | Adult Patients Screened | 1,499    | Paediatric Eye Surgeries      |
| 20,593           | Children Screened       | 1,25,893 | Free Adult Eye Surgeries      |
| 1,37,126         | Adult Eye Surgeries     | 1,486    | Free Paediatric Eye Surgeries |

| Patna  |                         | Dalsinghsarai |                         |
|--------|-------------------------|---------------|-------------------------|
| 19,553 | Adult Patients Screened | 39,752        | Adult Patients Screened |
| 1,166  | Children Screened       | 2,552         | Children Screened       |
| 8,589  | Eye Surgeries Performed | 12,641        | Eye Surgeries Performed |
| 7,949  | Free Eye Surgeries      | 11,593        | Free Eye Surgeries      |

| Purnea |                         | Ballia, Uttar Pradesh |                         |
|--------|-------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|
| 38,803 | Adult Patients Screened | 52,126                | Adult Patients Screened |
| 738    | Children Screened       | 13,330                | Eye Surgeries Performed |
| 12,384 | Eye Surgeries Performed | 9,705                 | Free Eye Surgeries      |
| 11,999 | Free Eye Surgeries      |                       |                         |

# Akhand Jyoti's Geographical Coverage

## One Village to Thousands of Communities

What began in the village of Mastichak has grown into one of the largest rural eye care networks in the region.

Today, Akhand Jyoti's hospitals and Vision Centres reach communities across Bihar, eastern Uttar Pradesh, and Uttarakhand, bringing quality eye care closer to people who would otherwise have to travel long distances or go without treatment altogether.

Every new centre represents something simple but powerful: one less barrier between a person and the care they need to see.

## Expanding Our Reach

New Vision Centres Opened in FY 2025-26

1. Motipur, Muzaffarpur
2. Benipatti, Madhubani
3. Bajpatti, Sitamarhi
4. Shahpur Patoree, Samastipur
5. Warisnagar, Samastipur
6. Katihar, Katihar
7. Kurhani, Muzaffarpur
8. Chhapra, Saran
9. Raxaul, East Champaran



## A Network Built for Access

With a network of around 50 Vision Centres and five Surgical Centres, including a Centre of Excellence, across Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand, Akhand Jyoti is building a robust rural eye care ecosystem designed to extend quality care to underserved communities.

Visit [www.akhandjyoti.com](http://www.akhandjyoti.com) to explore our complete network.

# Drishti Saathi

## Mobile Vision Vans Bringing Vision Closer to the Last-Mile Population

Not every community can easily reach an eye hospital. In many parts of rural Bihar, distance, limited transport, and the cost of travel can turn even a treatable eye condition into a long-delayed problem.

Drishti Saathi was created for these communities. Operating as mobile eye care units, these vision vans carry essential services directly to villages and remote settlements, bringing screenings, consultations, and referral services closer to people's doorsteps. Staffed by trained optometrists and community mobilisers, they ensure that individuals can access primary eye care without travelling long distances or incurring out-of-pocket expenses.

Each visit also strengthens the pathway to further care. Individuals requiring advanced treatment are connected to hospitals and surgical services within Akhand Jyoti's wider network, ensuring that geography does not determine whether someone receives timely intervention.

By taking eye care to places where fixed facilities are often difficult to access, Drishti Saathi extends the reach of the care delivery system and helps ensure that communities are not left behind because of where they live.

**Coverage:** Rural blocks across Bihar

**Workforce:** Trained optometrists and community mobilisers

**Purpose:** Early detection and zero out-of-pocket cost

## Impact Snapshot

FY 2025-26

68,006

People  
Screened

37,425

Male Beneficiaries  
Screened

30,581

Female Beneficiaries  
Screened



When People  
Can't Reach Care,  
Care Moves  
Towards Them

# Paediatric Eye Screening Programme

Earlier identification for better possibilities

Good vision plays an important role in how children learn, explore, and grow. Yet many childhood eye conditions remain unnoticed because young children often cannot recognise or describe changes in their vision. In rural Bihar, one in every 100\* children lives with visual impairment, while up to 19%\*\* of school-going children experience refractive errors, making early identification essential.

Akhand Jyoti's Paediatric Eye Screening Programme is designed to detect eye conditions at the earliest possible stage and ensure children receive timely diagnosis, treatment, or surgery before vision begins to affect their development. At the heart of the programme is Akhand Jyoti's Centre of Excellence, the only hospital in Bihar providing comprehensive paediatric eye care services under one roof, offering specialised care for a wide range of childhood eye conditions.

Complementing this effort is Bal Drishti, a CSR initiative supported by Bajaj Finserv, through which trained teams conduct vision screening in schools and Anganwadis, bringing eye care closer to where children learn and grow. Children requiring further evaluation are referred for specialised treatment, ensuring continuity of care from screening to recovery.

Together, these efforts are helping more children receive the right care at the right time, giving them a stronger foundation for learning, development, and a healthier future.

\*Source: Sinha A. et al. "Prevalence of Visual Impairment Among Children in Rural Bihar." International Journal of Pharmaceutical and Clinical Research, Vol. 14, Issue 5.

\*\*Source: Kumar S. et al. "Prevalence of Refractive Errors Among School-going Children." International Journal of Pharmaceutical and Clinical Research, Vol. 14, Issue 12.

## Impact Snapshot

FY 2025-26

1,478

Paediatric  
Surgeries

2,61,471

Total Children  
Screened

2,291

Eyeglasses Dispensed in  
Schools & Anganwadis

3,001

Schools & Anganwadis  
Visited



Some Vision Problems  
Begin Quietly,  
Early Screening Can  
Change What  
Comes Next

# Little Eyes, Big World

Story of  
Anushka Yadav



Anushka, just 8, could not read her books, play with friends, or even recognise the faces she loved. A squint had quietly stolen her sight, until an Akhand Jyoti outreach camp in Dada Ka Chapra, Ballia, gave her mother Renu Devi hope.

Diagnosed with congenital cataract, Anushka underwent surgery that changed everything. Today, she reads at home with confidence, walks proudly beside her mother, and stands tall on her own, no longer needing anyone to guide her steps.

Her family calls it a miracle. We call it what your support makes possible.



Stories of Change

# Centre of Excellence

## World Class Eye Care in Rural Bihar

For decades, advanced eye care in India has largely been concentrated in cities. Yet some of the country's greatest unmet healthcare needs continue to exist far beyond urban centres, where access to specialised treatment often remains limited.

Rural Bihar presented a different question: What would happen if world-class eye care was built not where healthcare was already abundant, but where the need was greatest?

For nearly two decades, Akhand Jyoti worked alongside rural communities, restoring sight and witnessing a growing reality. Every year, thousands

more people sought care and thousands more continued to live with avoidable blindness. The need kept growing, and so did the demand for advanced services, specialised treatment, and a stronger eye care ecosystem.

The answer was the Centre of Excellence. Inaugurated in 2023, the Centre of Excellence was deliberately established in rural Bihar, not in a metropolitan city. It was a conscious decision to bring world-class eye care to the very communities that needed it most. Today, the Centre stands not only as a hospital, but as a long-term investment in clinical excellence, research, learning, and the future capacity of rural eye care.



**We Believe  
When the Need  
Is Enormous,  
Excellence Must Scale**



# Building Capacity at Every Level

## A 500 Bed World-Class Hospital in the Heart of Rural Bihar

Today, the Centre of Excellence stands as Eastern India's largest eye hospital and a beacon of care, learning, and innovation. It was designed to address two challenges simultaneously: expanding access to advanced eye care and building the systems and expertise needed to serve millions more people in the future.

### The Centre's capabilities include:

Delivering world-class eye care through a 500-bed Centre of Excellence in rural Bihar.



Bihar's only centre bringing comprehensive paediatric eye care services under one roof.

10 OPD clinics designed to examine more than 800 patients every day.



11 fully equipped operation theatres supporting multiple ophthalmic specialities.

State-of-the-art Akhand Jyoti Labs advancing microbiology, histopathology, biochemistry, and molecular biology.



A 10-acre campus with 2,07,000 sq. ft. of built-up infrastructure.

Spacious Deluxe and Premium Wards designed for patient-friendly care and greater comfort.



Fellowship and advanced training programmes shaping the next generation of ophthalmologists and optometrists.

Dedicated superspeciality clinics for Retina, Glaucoma, Cornea, and Paediatric Ophthalmology, all under one roof.





Spacious, well-equipped auditoriums supporting smart classes, conferences, and academic learning.

Eye Bank and Corneal Transplant Unit providing sight-restoring care for patients with corneal blindness.



Research and innovation hub producing influential publications that shape rural eye care policy and practice.

## Impact Snapshot

FY 2025-26

**2,74,685**

Adult Patients  
Screened

**20,593**

Children  
Screened

**1,37,126**

Adult Eye  
Surgeries

**1,499**

Paediatric  
Eye Surgeries

**1,25,893**

Free Adult  
Eye Surgeries

**1,486**

Free Paediatric  
Eye Surgeries

# 'Football to Eyeball'

## Girls' Empowerment Programme

### From a Football Field to the Frontlines of Eye Care

Every girl carries within her the possibility of becoming something more than the world expects of her. Yet in many rural communities, opportunities to explore that potential can be limited by social expectations, unequal access to education, and circumstances that narrow choices long before adulthood begins.

The 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme was created to change this reality.

It began with a simple idea: if girls are given the opportunity to learn, lead, and build meaningful careers,

they can transform not only their own futures but also the communities around them.

The journey begins on a football field. For many girls, it is their first experience of teamwork, leadership, discipline, and the confidence that comes from being seen and heard. The game becomes a space where they learn to trust themselves and imagine possibilities that once seemed beyond reach.

## Impact Snapshot

FY 2025-26

**1,131 Girls**

Empowered  
(Since Inception  
of the  
programme)

**699 Girls**

Pursuing  
Optometry,  
BBA and  
EMA course

**728 Girls**

Currently  
Employed at  
Akhand Jyoti

**77 Girls**

in Leadership  
Roles

**19 Girls**

Represented  
Bihar in State &  
National Football  
Championship



# A Five-Year Journey, Growing with Purpose



## Stage 1 | The First Kick

It starts with football. For girls rarely allowed beyond their doorstep, the football field becomes the first space that is entirely theirs. Confidence grows. Barriers begin to fall.



## Stage 2 | The Foundation

Girls begin a one-year foundational course, building the academic base needed to qualify for university-level optometry. Self-sufficiency becomes a goal within reach.



## Stage 3 | The Degree

A rigorous four-year Bachelor of Optometry programme follows, with hands-on training and mentorship at Akhand Jyoti. Rural girls become skilled, certified optometrists.



## Stage 4 | The Career

Graduates join Akhand Jyoti with starting salaries at least five times their family's income, stepping into financial independence and professional identity.



## Stage 5 | The Legacy

Every graduate leaves as something greater than a qualified optometrist. Each girl becomes a community role model, inspiring the next generation to follow. Together, these women drive Akhand Jyoti's Blindness Elimination Programme, transforming a personal journey into a lasting movement of change.

This is the distinctive strength of the 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme. It addresses two challenges simultaneously: reducing gender inequality and building the future workforce required to expand access to quality eye care in underserved communities.

## Impact Snapshot

FY 2025-26

**150 Girls**

Enrolled in FY 2025-26

**400 Girls**

Expected New Enrolment  
in FY 2026-27

**69 Girls**

Expected New Employment  
in FY 2026-27

# The Game That Changed Her Direction

Story of  
**Surbhi Kumari**



Before Surbhi Kumari ever wore a white coat, she spent her afternoons on a football field. She joined Akhand Jyoti through the 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme at the age of eleven, never imagining the game she loved would shape her future. While representing India in football more than thirteen times, she completed both her Diploma and Bachelor's in Optometry, balancing training with lectures and clinical learning.

She now welcomes patients as an optometrist, while younger girls entering the programme see someone who once stood where they do. For Surbhi, the football field was where the journey began, and the profession she proudly serves today is where it has led.



Stories of Change

# Akhand Jyoti Institute of Community Ophthalmology (AJICO)

## Strengthening Public Eye Health Through Knowledge and Innovation

The future of eye care will be shaped not only by the hospitals we build, but also by the knowledge we generate, the professionals we prepare, and the innovations that make quality care accessible to every community. As Akhand Jyoti continues to expand its reach, it is equally strengthening the systems that will advance public eye health for years to come.

The Akhand Jyoti Institute of Community Ophthalmology (AJICO) was established as the organisation's dedicated public eye health vertical to advance research, education, training, and innovation in community ophthalmology. By developing evidence

driven and scalable models of care, AJICO aims to improve access to quality eye care for underserved populations while contributing to stronger, more responsive eye health systems.

Today, AJICO is nurturing the next generation of eye care professionals through Clinical Fellowships, Diplomate of National Board (DNB), Bachelor of Optometry (B.Optom), and Short-Term Training Programmes and Observerships, creating opportunities for continuous learning, clinical excellence, and collaborative research.

## AJICO at a Glance

**Dedicated  
Public Eye  
Health Vertical  
of Akhand Jyoti**

**Research,  
Education,  
Training, and  
Innovation**

**Clinical  
Fellowships**

**Diplomate of  
National  
Board (DNB)**

**Bachelor of  
Optometry  
(B.Optom)**

**Short-Term  
Training  
Programmes &  
Observerships**



## Sight for All Conclave 2026

Extending this commitment beyond education and research, AJICO convened the Sight for All Conclave 2026, bringing together more than 300 experts from over 30 leading eye care institutions at Akhand Jyoti's Centre of Excellence in Mastichak. The annual conclave

serves as a platform for collaboration, knowledge exchange, and evidence-based dialogue, encouraging collective action to strengthen public eye health and improve equitable access to quality eye care for underserved communities.

# Scaling Capacity Through Strategic Partnerships

## Akhand Jyoti Eye Hospital – Adani Centre for Eye Diseases (ACE) & Akhand Jyoti Institute of Community Ophthalmology – Adani Training Centre for Ophthalmic Medicine (ATOM)

Expanding access to quality eye care requires long term investments that strengthen healthcare infrastructure, build skilled professionals, and improve access for communities that remain underserved. As Akhand Jyoti continues to expand one of India's largest rural eye care ecosystems, strategic partnerships are helping accelerate this vision.

Recognising Akhand Jyoti's proven community-led model of delivering high quality eye care, the Adani Foundation partnered with the organisation in May 2026 to establish two landmark institutions at Mastichak: the Akhand Jyoti Eye Hospital – Adani Centre for Eye Diseases (ACE) and the Akhand Jyoti Institute of Community Ophthalmology – Adani Training Centre for Ophthalmic Medicine (ATOM).

Together, these initiatives will significantly strengthen Akhand Jyoti's capacity to deliver specialised eye care while preparing the next generation of eye health

professionals. The expanded Mastichak ecosystem is expected to increase its annual surgical capacity from 1,85,500+ to approximately 3,30,000 eye surgeries, while ATOM will train nearly 1,000 eye health professionals every year, strengthening the eye care workforce for underserved regions.

Complementing these investments in infrastructure and workforce, the partnership also introduced 10 patient transport buses to improve last mile connectivity, making it easier for patients from remote communities to access timely treatment.

The partnership was formally marked by the Bhumi Pujan for both institutions in the presence of Shri Gautam Adani, Chairman of the Adani Group, and Dr Priti Adani, Chairperson of the Adani Foundation, reaffirming a shared commitment to expanding equitable eye care across rural India.

## The Scale of What's Ahead



# The Childhood That Found Its Light

Story of  
Anish Kumar



Stories of Change

Every morning, Anish Kumar is eager to be wherever the action is. He follows his parents around the house, runs after the other children in the village, and rarely sits still for long. It is hard to imagine the worry that once filled his home. His parents first noticed a white spot in his eyes and soon learnt that he had congenital cataract.

Fearing he might never experience childhood as they had imagined, they sought treatment at Akhand Jyoti. After his sight was restored, those fears gradually gave way to relief. Now, watching Anish race after his friends is all the reassurance his parents ever hoped for.



# Vision 2030



## An Ambitious Step Towards Eliminating Blindness by Creating a Strong Female Workforce

Over the last two decades, Akhand Jyoti has demonstrated that quality eye care can thrive even in places where access has historically been limited. Millions of people have regained sight, communities have gained trusted pathways to care, and hundreds of rural girls have emerged as eye care professionals and leaders. Yet the need remains immense still.

Millions continue to live with avoidable blindness, the

demand for eye care services continues to grow, and significant gaps in infrastructure and human resources persist across rural India.

Vision 2030 is our response to this reality. It is an ambitious commitment to build the systems, people, and capacity required to eliminate avoidable blindness at scale while creating opportunities for the next generation of women leaders in healthcare.

### By 2030, Akhand Jyoti aims to achieve:

- 20,00,000 sight restoring surgeries
- 1,20,00,000 eye screenings
- 1,500 rural girls empowered

These are more than numerical targets. They represent our commitment to creating a future where quality eye care and opportunity are within reach for every community.

### Closing Bihar's Surgical Gap

Bihar continues to carry one of India's largest burdens of avoidable blindness while performing significantly fewer eye surgeries than the national average. To bridge this gap, Akhand Jyoti aims to substantially increase surgical output by expanding access to screenings, strengthening referral pathways, and bringing timely treatment closer to communities.

By increasing surgical capacity, we aim to move Bihar closer to the national benchmark while reducing the backlog of untreated cataracts and other avoidable eye conditions.



### Building Capacity for 5,00,000+ Surgeries a Year

Meeting Bihar's growing eye care needs requires a significant expansion in surgical capacity. By 2030, Akhand Jyoti aims to perform 5,00,000+ eye surgeries annually, enabling hundreds of thousands more people to receive timely, sight-restoring treatment every year.

This expansion represents more than an increase in numbers. It is an investment in the infrastructure, systems, and workforce needed to deliver quality eye care at unprecedented scale.

### Building the Future Workforce of Rural Eye Care

A key component of Vision 2030 is the commitment to empower 1,500 rural girls through the 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme.

Through education, residential support, and professional training in optometry, these young women will become the next generation of eye care professionals, entrepreneurs, and community leaders. In doing so, the programme addresses gender inequality while strengthening the workforce required to expand quality eye care across underserved communities.





### Building Evidence for Better Eye Care

Akhand Jyoti aims to produce 50 research papers and projects annually, placing innovation and evidence at the centre of its work.

This will contribute to a data-driven and integrated model of eye care, combining primary, secondary, and tertiary services into a system that can serve as a replicable model for rural India and other underserved regions.

### Expanding the Rural Eye Care Grid

From 48 Vision Centres in FY 2025-26, Akhand Jyoti aims to scale to 300 Vision Centres by 2029.

This expanded network will bring primary eye care closer to communities, strengthen referral pathways, and create an interconnected rural eye care grid capable of serving millions more people.



### Building the Talent Pipeline for Rural Eye Care

The Integrated Training Centre will house smart classrooms, laboratories, simulation facilities, and auditoriums, with the capacity to train thousands of eye health professionals annually.

By investing in learning and professional development, the Centre will help address Bihar's shortage of ophthalmologists and optometrists while strengthening the long term sustainability of rural eye care.

### Bringing Eye Care Closer to Every Community

With 50 girls leading operations at Integrated Tele Eye Health Centres, Akhand Jyoti is leveraging digital technology to expand screenings, strengthen awareness initiatives, and deliver preventive eye care to thousands of rural households, including those in some of Bihar's most remote communities.





### Strengthening the Foundations of Care

Akhand Jyoti plans to expand its hospitals in Muzaffarpur, Dalsinghsarai, and Ballia to 200 beds each.

This expansion will increase access to advanced eye care while strengthening regional capacity and reducing the need for patients to travel long distances for treatment.

### Taking Quality Eye Care to New Regions

Five new 200-bed Greenfield eye hospitals will be established in Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Jharkhand, and Madhya Pradesh.

These hospitals will extend the reach of quality eye care into underserved regions while creating the infrastructure required to meet future demand.



### Building a Home for the Workforce of Tomorrow

The foundation for a mini township with residential units, a school, and recreational facilities has been laid at Mastichak.

Designed to support faculty, healthcare professionals, and their families, the township will create an environment that attracts and retains talent while strengthening the long term sustainability of the mission.

### Building the Digital Backbone of Growth

A robust digital infrastructure will support patient care, education, research, outreach, and administration across Akhand Jyoti's expanding network.

Technology will play a critical role in improving efficiency, supporting informed decision-making, and enabling the organisation to operate effectively at a greater scale.



# Looking Ahead

Projection for FY 2026-27

## Creating Space for More Dreams

Construction of the second phase of the 800 bed Girls' Hostel will commence, expanding residential capacity for girls enrolled in the 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme. The expansion will enable more rural girls to access education, training, and mentorship, strengthening the future eye care workforce.



## Building the Environment Where Futures Can Grow

Akhand Jyoti is planning to develop a 320-bed Girls' Hostel Complex at its Centre of Excellence campus in Mastichak, Bihar. Designed to support the 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme, the hostel will provide a safe residential environment for girls pursuing education, sports, vocational training, and careers in eye care. By enabling more rural girls to access these opportunities, the project will play a key role in advancing Vision 2030 and the goal of empowering 1,500 rural girls as future eye care professionals and community leaders.

## The Milestones We Are Working Towards

Building on the progress of FY 2025-26, the year ahead marks another important step in Akhand Jyoti's journey of growth and expansion.

As new facilities become operational, partnerships deepen, and capacity continues to grow, the organisation remains firmly committed to its Vision 2030 goals and to creating a future where quality eye care and opportunity reach every community that needs them most.



# Aligning with Global SDGs

## Advancing 6 Key Sustainable Development Goals through Our Initiatives

Building on the progress of FY 2025-26, the year ahead marks another important step in Akhand Jyoti's journey of growth and expansion.

As new facilities become operational, partnerships deepen, and capacity continues to grow, the organisation remains firmly committed to its Vision 2030 goals and to creating a future where quality eye care and opportunity reach every community that needs them most.

**1 NO POVERTY**



**No Poverty:** Sight-restoring surgeries for low-income communities help individuals regain their livelihoods and break the cycle of poverty.

**3 GOOD HEALTH AND WELL-BEING**



**Good Health and Well-Being :** Empowering young women to eliminate blindness significantly improves the quality of life for individuals and communities.

**4 QUALITY EDUCATION**



**Quality Education :** Educating and nurturing rural girls to become qualified optometrists.

**5 GENDER EQUALITY**



**Gender Equality :** Uplifting underprivileged girls and empowering them to become change agents.

**8 DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROWTH**



**Decent Work and Economic Growth:** Restoring sight enables the underprivileged to return to work and regain their livelihoods.

**10 REDUCED INEQUALITIES**



**Reduced Inequalities:** Access to quality eye care and education helps bridge social and economic gaps for underserved populations.



**Clear Sight Gives  
Childhood  
More Room to Grow**

# The Hands That Feed Tomorrow

Story of  
Sharda Devi



Sharda Devi has spent years looking after others. As an Anganwadi cook in Birpur, Bhojpur, she worked to support her family and her son. But cataract slowly changed her life. For more than two years, she struggled to see and began depending on her son for things she once managed herself. Her family worried as they watched the woman they had always relied on begin to need their help.

After learning about Akhand Jyoti through an advertisement, Sharda went for a screening and underwent cataract surgery. Today, she is back at the Anganwadi, cooking and working again. She can see clearly, earn for her family and once again be there for them.



Stories of Change

# Milestones of Growth

Celebrating a year of progress, reach, and impact

## A Wider Network for Wider Access

The year began with Akhand Jyoti extending its network across Bihar, bringing primary eye care closer to communities that remain underserved. New Vision Centres were established in Raxaul in East Champaran, with support from CharityVision; Chhapra in Saran, with Siemens Healthineers; Kurhani in Muzaffarpur, with Bhupendra Babu; and Katihar. The network expanded further in Samastipur, with centres in Warisnagar, Tajpur and Shahpur Patori supported by Standard Chartered and Sightsavers, alongside three centres supported by Seva Foundation in Bajpatti, Benipatti, and Motipur.

Together, these additions strengthened the continuum between community-level screening and hospital-based care, bringing quality eye care within easier reach of more communities across Bihar.



## Expanding Global Learning Partnerships



Akhand Jyoti initiated a collaboration with Authentica and The University of Texas at Austin, welcoming Helena Wilkins-Versalovic and Ravi Raj to its campus. The partnership creates opportunities for students to engage directly with Akhand Jyoti's work across healthcare, education and gender equity, combining academic learning with field-based experience and a deeper understanding of community-led development.

# Milestones of Growth

Celebrating a year of progress, reach, and impact

## Sharing Our Model on a Global Stage

Dr. Ajit Kumar Poddar, Medical Director, represented Akhand Jyoti at the SAO-APAO-AIOS 2025 Scientific Session, Pearls from Best Practice. As speaker, panellist and co-chair, he presented Akhand Jyoti's approach to sustainable, community-centred eye care, leadership, innovation, research and community integration—sharing the journey from a 10-bed hospital to a super-speciality institution serving rural communities.



## Recognition for Clinical Excellence



Dr Afroz Alam, Chief Medical Officer (Academic & Research), received the Best Hyde Park Session Award - Cataract (Joint Winner) at APAO-AIOS 2025 for his presentation on the relationship between surgical volume and intra-operative complications in Manual Small Incision Cataract Surgery. The recognition reinforced Akhand Jyoti's commitment to delivering high-volume care without compromising clinical quality. He also contributed as faculty to surgical skills transfer courses in Phacoemulsification, SICS and Anterior Vitrectomy.

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## International Recognition for Surgical Innovation

Dr Santosh Kumar, Head of the Retina Department, presented his innovative technique, Proportional Hydroreflux for Membrane Peeling in Diabetic Tractional Retinal Detachment, at APAO-AIOS 2025. The work received international recognition for demonstrating a precise and controlled approach to the management of complex diabetic retinal conditions.



## Advancing Evidence through Research



Dr Sumit Randhir Singh, Senior Consultant, Vitreo-Retina, presented findings from a multicentric study on delayed rhegmatogenous retinal detachment after macular surgery at APAO-AIOS 2025. Published in Retina, the research adds to Akhand Jyoti's growing contribution to clinical knowledge and advances its commitment to evidence-based care and the research ambitions of Vision 2030.

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## Strengthening Clinical Knowledge

Akhand Jyoti organised a Continuing Medical Education session on Glaucoma and Neuro-ophthalmology, bringing together ophthalmologists and eye care professionals from across India. The programme focused on emerging approaches to early detection, diagnosis and management, strengthening clinical knowledge and supporting high-quality eye care delivery.



## Honoured for Community Eye Care Leadership

Dr Ajit Kumar Poddar, Medical Director of Akhand Jyoti Eye Hospital, received the Pride of Patna Award at Dainik Jagran iNext's My Patna My Pride event in recognition of his contribution to community ophthalmology. The award was presented by Nand Kishore Yadav.



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## Creating Space for Knowledge and Opportunity

Krishan Kumar Mantoo inaugurated the Shriram Auditorium at Akhand Jyoti's Centre of Excellence in Mastichak, Saran. Established with support from the Nalanda Foundation, the 360-seat state-of-the-art facility will host CME programmes, clinical training, conferences and the 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme—creating a dedicated platform for learning, skill development and knowledge exchange.



## Taking Care Closer to the Last Mile

Akhand Jyoti expanded its community patient transport fleet with three new buses, flagged off at the Centre of Excellence, Mastichak, with support from GIC Housing Finance Ltd. The initiative strengthens the link between rural communities and hospital-based care, helping patients from remote and underserved areas reach the treatment they need.



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## Welcoming the Next Generation of Changemakers

150 new girls joined the 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme. Many are first-generation learners from remote villages, beginning a journey that will equip them to become optometrists and contribute to the communities they come from. Their induction brings Akhand Jyoti closer to its Vision 2030 goal of empowering 1,500 girls.



## Laying the Foundation for a Stronger Campus Ecosystem

A Bhoomi Puja and Yagya marked the beginning of Akhand Jyoti's Mini Township at Mastichak. The integrated facility will bring together staff housing, expanded hostel capacity and community spaces, strengthening the wider ecosystem required to support the organisation's growing scale and ambitions.



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## Extending Care Beyond Clinical Treatment

More than 2,000 families from vulnerable communities received dry ration kits during the quarter. By helping patients and caregivers navigate periods of food insecurity, the initiative extended Akhand Jyoti's approach to care beyond the operating theatre — recognising that health outcomes are shaped by the wider realities of people's lives.



## Exploring Partnerships for Greater Impact



Akhand Jyoti welcomed senior leadership from CreditAccess Grameen and India Foundation. The visit opened dialogue around scaling community eye health, advancing women's empowerment and exploring opportunities for meaningful CSR collaboration.

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## Promoting Holistic Well-being

Participants of the 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme marked International Yoga Day through a dedicated yoga session. Aligned with the theme One Earth, One Health, the initiative reinforced the importance of holistic well-being alongside education, empowerment and professional development.



## Building A Space for Girls and Healthcare



Two significant facilities were commissioned during the year, with the support of General Insurance Corporation of India (GIC Re). Lopamudra Bhawan, a safe residential facility for more than 200 rural girls, was inaugurated in the presence of Hon'ble Education Minister Sunil Kumar and Dr N. Vijayalakshmi. Alongside it, an 800-kW solar power plant among the largest for a non-profit hospital in the region began supplying clean, reliable energy to support surgeries and hospital services.

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## Convening Leaders for Collective Impact

The 14th Bihar Development Collective Meet brought together more than 60 changemakers representing over 50 NGOs and social enterprises at the Centre of Excellence. The gathering created space for dialogue on rural development, health equity and local leadership, reinforcing the value of collective action in addressing complex community challenges.



## Building Purpose-Driven Leadership



A leadership workshop with Shri Ravi Kant and Shri Rajesh Shrivastav equipped more than 100 staff members with tools for mindful and purpose-driven leadership, strengthening the organisational culture required to sustain Akhand Jyoti's growing scale and impact.

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## Reaffirming Our Commitment to Quality Care

Akhand Jyoti underwent an ISO certification audit as part of its continuing commitment to maintaining high standards of quality assurance and clinical excellence. The process reinforced the systems and disciplines required to deliver consistent, reliable care at scale.



## Celebrating the People Behind Our Purpose

Akhand Jyoti marked National Doctor's Day by recognising the dedication of its ophthalmologists and medical teams serving communities across rural Bihar. With more than 1,85,500 surgeries performed annually, the occasion acknowledged the professionals whose expertise helps restore sight, protect livelihoods and advance the mission to eliminate curable blindness.



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## Powering Care Through Clean Energy

A 100-kW solar power plant was commissioned at the Centre of Excellence with support from Group Legrand India under its Green Energy Project. The installation strengthens the reliability of hospital operations and sight-restoring surgeries while advancing the organisation's commitment to renewable energy.



## Recognised for Excellence in Community Ophthalmology



Akhand Jyoti received the Sant Hirdaram Sewa Sadan Award at the 19th Annual Conference of VISION 2020: The Right to Sight - INDIA in Ahmedabad. A team of 20 professionals, led by Medical Director Dr Ajit Kumar Poddar, represented the organisation and presented work spanning AI-enabled community screening, Vision Centre models, school eye health and the socio-economic impact of cataract surgery.

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## Strengthening Academic Collaboration

Dr Bindey Kumar, Vice Chancellor of Bihar University of Health Sciences and Director of IGIMS, visited Akhand Jyoti's Centre of Excellence. His interaction with the leadership team and Football to Eyeball trainees opened dialogue on academic collaboration, with a focus on strengthening training, research and rural eye care.



## Celebrating Our People and Purpose



UMANG 2025 brought together doctors, optometrists, students and staff from across Akhand Jyoti at Mastichak on 3 August. The annual gathering recognised excellence across categories including Lifetime Achievement, Best Employee, Student of the Year, Best Optometrist and departmental performance. Discussions on Vision 2030 and leadership reinforced a shared direction, while the participation of Dr Ashok Choudhary, Hon'ble Minister, Rural Works Department, Government of Bihar, reaffirmed support for Akhand Jyoti's mission of providing free eye surgeries to underserved communities.

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## Building the Next Generation of Women Eye Care Professionals

The foundation stone was laid for an 800-capacity Girls' Hostel under SBI Foundation's Sashakti Project. Planned in two phases, the facility will accommodate 400 girls in each phase. In Phase I, SBI Foundation and SBI Card will support accommodation for 248 girls, while Akhand Jyoti will support the remaining 152, strengthening the pathway for rural girls to access education and optometry training under Vision 2030.



## Champions On and Off the Field



Riya, Shamma, and Shabana were selected for the Bihar U-14 State Football Team to represent the state at the national championship in Assam. All three are part of Akhand Jyoti's 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme and train at the Akhand Jyoti Aarush Football Academy under Coach Rajan Singh. Their selection took the total number of girls from the programme to compete at state and national football championships to 19.

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## Honouring Social Impact Leadership

Akhand Jyoti Co-Founder & CEO, Mr Mritunjay Tiwary, was conferred the Pandit Rajkumar Shukla Shikhar Samman for Social Impact on 23 August 2025 at Vidyapati Bhawan, Patna. The recognition acknowledged his contribution to eye care and social service in Bihar. The award was presented by Shri Ravi Shankar Prasad, Member of Parliament, Patna Sahib Lok Sabha, and accepted on his behalf by Abhishek Kumar, Trustee & AGM Operations, Akhand Jyoti Eye Hospital.



## Reimagining Preventive Eye Care Through AI



Akhand Jyoti launched Healthy Eyes, Bihar's first AI-powered eye screening initiative, alongside Anmol Jyoti, a comprehensive eye wellness package offering 12 eye tests, 30 blood tests and five specialist consultations for adults aged 40 and above. The new model brings together AI-driven mass screening, the Anmol Jyoti Eye Wellness Package, Vision Lounge and Vision Studio, creating a broader continuum of preventive, primary and specialist eye care. The initiative supports Akhand Jyoti's ambition of conducting 12 million eye screenings by 2030.

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## Introducing a New Era of Urban Eye Care

Akhand Jyoti inaugurated its first Vision Lounge in Patna, introducing a new model of urban eye care that combines AI-enabled screening, preventive services, specialist consultations and advanced optical care. The initiative extends the organisation's continuum of care beyond rural outreach, responding to the growing need for accessible and comprehensive eye wellness.



## Taking AI-Powered Screening to the Railways

On World Sight Day 2025, Akhand Jyoti partnered with the Ministry of Railways, Government of India, to take the Healthy Eyes campaign to five major railway stations—Patna Junction, Rajendra Nagar Terminal, Hajipur, Patliputra and Danapur Junction. Thousands of passengers received free AI-enabled eye screenings, instant reports and referrals for further care, marking Bihar's first large-scale AI-led preventive eye care programme delivered in partnership with Indian Railways.



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## The Next Chapter of Rural Eye Care

Building Tomorrow's Eye Care Ecosystem from the Heart Of Bihar

On 13 September 2025, the journey towards the RLJ Akhand Jyoti Eye Hospital Community Centre took a significant step forward with the Kalash Sthapna ceremony for the upcoming 1,000-bed facility. The ceremony was attended by Shri J.P. Nadda, Hon'ble Union Minister of Health & Family Welfare, Government of India, Shri Samrat Choudhary, Hon'ble Deputy Chief Minister of Bihar, and other dignitaries.

A week later, on 20 September 2025, Akhand Jyoti, in partnership with Sankara Eye Foundation, USA, marked the Bhumi Pujan of the Community Centre. The ceremony brought together Shri Samrat Choudhary, Hon'ble Deputy Chief Minister of Bihar; Shri Krishan Kumar Mantoo, Hon'ble Minister of Information Technology, Government of Bihar; Dr V. Anantha Nageswaran, Chief Economic Adviser, Government of India; and Shri Radhakrishnan Sundar, Sankara Eye Foundation, USA.

Twenty years after Akhand Jyoti began its journey in Mastichak with a modest hospital and a belief that quality eye care should reach underserved communities, the next chapter is now taking shape.



Connected to the existing Centre of Excellence, the RLJ Akhand Jyoti Eye Hospital Community Centre is envisioned as the world's largest standalone eye care ecosystem, bringing together treatment, training, research and innovation.

The first purpose-built block will house 1,000 beds and 19 operation theatres, with the capacity to perform more than 3,00,000 free eye surgeries annually. A second block will strengthen outpatient services, and house advanced diagnostic and AI-enabled research laboratories focused on genomics, proteomics and stem cell studies.

Supported by Sankara Eye Foundation, USA, as the anchor donor, the Community Centre will also build the next generation of eye care professionals, including ophthalmologists, optometrists and allied professionals, with opportunities for girls from the 'Football to Eyeball' Girls' Empowerment Programme.

More than an expansion of infrastructure, the Community Centre is being built to strengthen Bihar's capacity to address avoidable blindness at scale and shape a sustainable, world-class model of rural eye care.

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## Contributing to National Scientific Discourse

Akhand Jyoti participated in the 4th AIOS Mid-Term Conference in Amritsar from 26-28 September 2025. Under the mentorship of Dr. Ajit Kumar Poddar, Dr. Shankar Narayan A and Dr. Sadyaja Smita presented papers through the AIOS Teachers of Tomorrow programme on Fundus Fluorescein Angiography and congenital glaucoma. Dr. Poddar also delivered a faculty lecture on innovation and challenges in cataract and IOL surgery and chaired multiple scientific sessions.



## National Recognition for Inclusive Healthcare



Shri Mritunjay Tiwary, Co-Founder & CEO, Akhand Jyoti Eye Hospital, received the Regional Award - East Zone in the Inclusive Healthcare & Accessibility category at the Forbes India We Serve India Season 2 - North & East Zone Awards, presented by Lions Clubs International in Lucknow. The award was received on his behalf by Mr. Rakesh Kumar, Chief Operating Officer (Operations), Akhand Jyoti Eye Hospital.

# Milestones of Growth

Celebrating a year of progress, reach, and impact

## Recognising Excellence in Community Outreach

Akhand Jyoti's Half-Yearly Outreach Team Meet brought together its community outreach teams to review progress, recognise performance and strengthen the work of identifying patients and conducting screenings across rural Bihar. Awards recognised top-performing team members whose efforts help connect underserved communities with timely eye care.



## Partnering to Advance Public Eye Health

Akhand Jyoti signed an MoU with PRASHO Foundation, Hyderabad, to establish a Public Eye Health vertical. Led by Dr G. V. S. Murthy, Founder, PRASHO Foundation, the partnership will strengthen the prevention of avoidable blindness and visual impairment through public health research, capacity building, epidemiological studies and community awareness.



# Milestones of Growth

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## Uniting Leaders for Last-Mile Impact

Akhand Jyoti organised the India for Bharat Conclave 2025 in New Delhi under the theme Uniting Towards Reaching the Last-Mile Populations. The conclave brought together leaders from government, industry and the development sector to explore collaborative solutions for improving access to healthcare and essential services in underserved communities.



## Five Years of Consistent Eye Care in Purnea



Akhand Jyoti Eye Hospital, Purnea, marked its fifth anniversary, recognising the contribution of employees, outreach teams and community partners across Purnea, Katihar, Araria and Madhepura. Five years of surgeries, outreach camps and follow-up care have strengthened the region's access to quality eye care. Hon'ble Minister Shri Lesi Singh, Minister of Food and Consumer Protection, Bihar, attended as Chief Guest, with Shri Pappu Yadav, MP, Purnea, as Special Guest.

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## Seeing Childhood Clearly

To mark Children's Day, Akhand Jyoti organised special eye screening and engagement programmes for paediatric patients. Alongside eye check-ups, the initiative included creative activities and family participation, reinforcing the importance of detecting and treating eye conditions early—before vision loss can affect learning, development and a child's ability to participate fully in the world around them.



## Driving Better Care Through Better Data

Akhand Jyoti, in partnership with PRASHO Foundation, Hyderabad, organised a three-day workshop on Performance Auditing and Data Management for Eye Care Programmes. Bringing together 36 delegates, the workshop strengthened capabilities in performance auditing, data collection and interpretation, Root Cause Analysis, monitoring indicators and activity-based quality improvement—enabling more informed decisions and stronger programme delivery.



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## Taking Eye Care Beyond Hospital Walls

With support from the Rotary Club of Pataliputra, Akhand Jyoti inducted a state-of-the-art Vision Van at its Centre of Excellence in Mastichak. The mobile eye clinic is designed to conduct 30,000 free eye screenings and facilitate more than 5,000 free eye surgeries annually, extending the reach of eye care into communities where distance remains a barrier.



## Introducing Corneal Transplant Services



Akhand Jyoti successfully performed its first corneal transplant—Therapeutic Penetrating Keratoplasty—at the Centre of Excellence. The surgery, performed on a 31-year-old patient with a severe corneal infiltrate, was led by Dr Ujjwal Prakash Jha, Senior Consultant - Cornea, with support from the clinical team. The milestone marks the introduction of corneal transplant services at Akhand Jyoti and expands its capacity to address complex corneal conditions.

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## Honoured for Values-Driven Leadership

Shri Mritunjay Tiwary, Co-Founder & CEO, Akhand Jyoti Eye Hospital, was honoured at the 100th Centenary Celebration 2026 of the Akhil Vishva Gayatri Parivar at Shantikunj. The recognition, presented by Dr Chinmay Pandya, Pro Vice Chancellor, Dev Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya, acknowledged values-driven leadership and Akhand Jyoti's women-led approach to eliminating avoidable blindness.



## Advancing Neonatal Eye Care



Akhand Jyoti hosted the National Scientific Symposium on Retinopathy of Prematurity as part of its annual Retina Classes knowledge series at the Centre of Excellence. The two-day programme brought together more than 100 ophthalmologists and retina specialists from across India for hands-on learning, and CME focused on early detection and management of ROP. During the symposium, Dr Ajit Kumar Poddar announced a state-wide free eye-screening programme for premature babies across Bihar, strengthening the focus on early detection, referral and prevention of ROP-related blindness.

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## Uniting Communities Against Glaucoma

During World Glaucoma Week 2026, Akhand Jyoti conducted community awareness campaigns across villages to encourage early detection and regular screening under the theme Uniting for a Glaucoma-Free World. Free glaucoma medicines were also distributed to underserved rural patients, supporting treatment continuity and reducing the risk of avoidable vision loss.



## Recognised for Expanding Access Through PM-JAY



Akhand Jyoti was recognised for its implementation of the Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PM-JAY/Ayushman Bharat). The hospital was honoured for delivering more than 48,000 eye surgeries under PM-JAY during FY 2025-26, extending high-volume, high-quality eye care to underserved communities. The recognition also acknowledged the hospital's surgical outcomes and efficient PM-JAY pre-authorisation processes.

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## Advancing Research Through Oculomics

The Oculomics Study received approval from the Clinical Trials Registry - India (CTRI), marking an important step in Akhand Jyoti's research journey. Alongside its three existing centres in the district, the network now comprises six Vision Centres, all women-led, with clinical services delivered by women. The model demonstrates how expanding access to primary eye care can also create meaningful employment opportunities for rural women.



## Empowering People Through Partnerships



Throughout FY 2025-26, Akhand Jyoti welcomed partners and supporters from across the development, financial and corporate sectors, including Adani Group, Seva Foundation, SBI Foundation, IOCL, MCX, Cure Blindness Project, CreditAccess Grameen, Jana Small Finance Bank, IDBI Bank, India Foundation, AICIL, CMS, Standard Chartered, SBI Card and Payment Services Limited, and BPCL.

These engagements created opportunities to understand Akhand Jyoti's work more closely, exchange perspectives and explore the systems required to build sustainable rural healthcare. More than visits, they became spaces for dialogue, shared learning and a deeper understanding of how partnerships can strengthen access to quality, equitable and enduring eye care.

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## Strengthening Care Through Medical Equipment Support

BPCL and IDBI Bank Limited extended valuable support to Akhand Jyoti, strengthening the infrastructure, equipment and resources required to deliver quality eye care at scale. While BPCL's support contributed to enhancing the hospital's clinical infrastructure, IDBI Bank Limited supported the provision of essential ophthalmic diagnostic equipment and enabled cataract and corneal treatments for underserved communities in Bihar. Together, these partnerships have strengthened clinical capabilities and expanded access to timely, quality eye care, reflecting the shared commitment of Akhand Jyoti and its partners to restoring sight and transforming lives.



# Partners Speak

Perspectives on the impact we share

# Partners in Purpose

Together, turning shared commitment into lasting change



# Partners in Purpose

Together, turning shared commitment into lasting change

**NUTANIX**



**SANKARA**  
EYE FOUNDATION, USA

**Savitri**  
THE SAVITRI WANNEY CHARITABLE TRUST



**SEABIRD**

LOGISTICS  
& BEYOND.  
DELIVERED.

**SIEMENS**  
**Healthineers**



standard  
chartered

**talbro****OS**



**TATA CAPITAL**  
Count on us



**TATA HITACHI**

Reliable solutions

**Manyavar**

**legrand**

**V-GUARD**

**YUVA**  
NSTOPPABLE

**MCX**



A CSR Initiative by  
**kotak neo**

**IHCL**

**SBI FOUNDATION**  
Service Beyond Banking

**SBI card**



**IDBI BANK**



**seva.org**

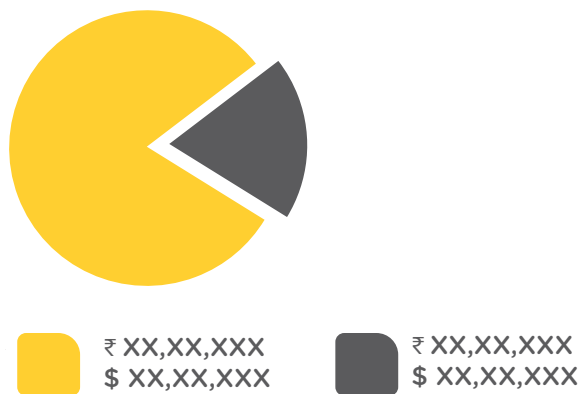
**JANA**  
Small Finance Bank



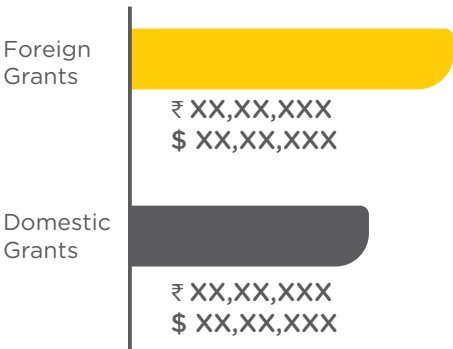
# Financial Overview

## Required Subhead

Total Donation / Grant Received  
₹ XX,XX,XXX | \$ XX,XX,XXX

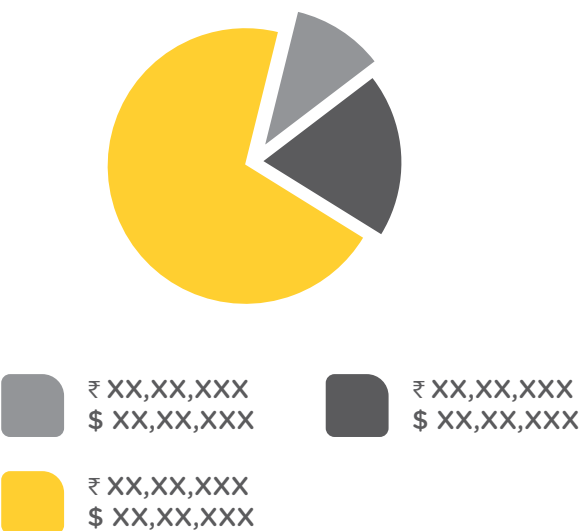


Total Donation / Grant Received  
₹ XX,XX,XXX | \$ XX,XX,XXX

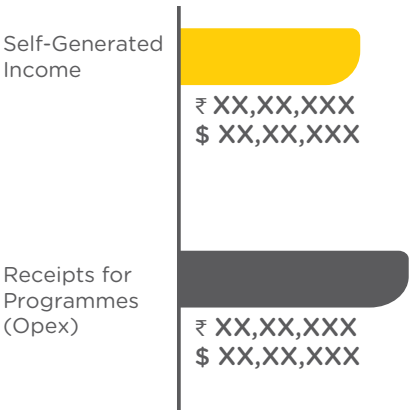


- Receipts for Programmes (Opex)
- Receipts for Capital Projects (Capex)

Total Spend - Projects & Programmes  
₹ XX,XX,XXX | \$ XX,XX,XXX



Total Income (Opex)



- Programmes Spend (Opex)
- Administration Cost
- Projects Spend (Capex)

Exchange Rate: 1USD=XXX INR (as on 31st March 2026)



Together,  
We're Making a  
Clearer Future

”



### Akhand Jyoti Eye Hospital

A unit of Yugrishi Shriram Sharma Acharya Charitable Trust

#### Corporate Office

Mastichak, Saran, Bihar- 841219, India

#### Registered Office

16C, Seal Lane, Mezzanine Floor,  
Kolkata- 700015, India

[www.akhandjyoti.org](http://www.akhandjyoti.org)



**siliconindia** 10 MOST PROMISING  
**HOSPITAL BRANDS**  
2022



**SocioFare Award  
2025**



Recognised for empowering rural girls through education, independence, and leadership



**Best Last-Mile  
Champion for Girls' Rights  
2024**



Recognised for transforming the lives of underprivileged girls in underserved communities.



**Rural India Healthcare  
Excellence Award  
2022**



Recognised for high-quality, high-volume eye care delivery in low-income regions of India.



**Dr. Jordan Kassalow  
VisionSpring Award  
2021**



Recognised for long-term commitment to tackling avoidable blindness.



**Access Champion Award  
2019**



Recognised for improving rural healthcare access for India's poorest communities.